

engage with the relevant authorities and share our perspective on future standards.



On IPO plans and the path to profitability:

We were very close to filing. We saw the markets turn softer and the global geopolitical situation take over. We as a board took a call to do it later. It could be later this year or early next year because we're ready... Our investors are very supportive... There's no urgency for us to list. Our Ola Cabs business is profitable... That's why we don't need to perpetually keep raising funds. When we come to the market, some people will be positively surprised... On our electric vehicles business front, we're the largest EV-revenue company in India, ahead of Tata Motors, which sells cars. We have more monthly revenue than them. [Within] four months of our launch of Ola Electric, we were No. 1 by market share. By numbers we would be 25-30 per cent of the EV two-wheeler market. On Ola Electric, when we come out with our financials, people will be surprised to see our capital efficiency. We would beat all incumbents hands down. Our target profitability will be early next year for the two-wheeler business.



On the electric car:

Our vision for Ola Electric is to accelerate the e-mobil-

ity transition in India and to become a global leader in new-energy domains... our vision is to build the world's largest two-wheeler product portfolio and manufacturing scale, sell in India, sell in key markets like Asean, LatAm, Europe, etc., and also build cars and focus on segments relevant to India like mid-sized and small cars.

In the EV four-wheeler landscape globally, Tesla started the game; their cheapest car is Model 3, a \$50,000-60,000 car, which is expensive for most parts of the world. Most European and American

launch in two years from now and build a fresh product and a factory for it.



On legacy players:

They [the legacy players] know the ICE [internal combustion engine] vehicle game, which is very different from the EV game. This [EV] is much more core technology. And we have many more engineers and much more capability around all aspects of EV technology. The game has changed. They don't know the game, we [do]. I run a million-plus drivers every day. Traditional automak-

talking about profitability four years ago. We've to focus a lot more on value creation rather than valuation. 'Funding winters' are cycles which come and go... In general, companies should focus on business fundamentals than vanity growth. This is the time when a lot of vanity growth companies will be separated from the ones who've genuinely built value. Valuations can fluctuate but that doesn't bother me. Our capital profile is fairly broad. We're much smarter about capital efficiency; we don't have the need to keep raising [capital] every

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carmakers are focussed on that segment. We want to be the world leaders in four-wheelers in mass market vehicles—₹10-30 lakh. There's a range of products relevant to India which nobody is investing big in and creating genuinely disruptive products. The third part is to build our own technology and building the cell will enable this whole revolution. We're setting up a very large cell innovation centre and have 100 engineers working on that. That's why I say Tesla for the West, Ola for the rest. We're looking to

ers don't even do any core technologies themselves, they just assemble. They're reliant on the supplier ecosystem and we're building our own. They're largely a sales and marketing company and that too they... sell to dealers... They don't know how to maintain customer relationships; [I do] because I come from consumer internet [and] have 150 million consumer relationships.



On funding:

I was the only one in the start-up community

few months. Investors will have their own business models and challenges. Tech valuations have gone down and these are cycles which evolve. Periodically we've given exits to investors. In six months, things will be more optimistic, investors will be happy again but our strategy is not dependent on our investors' mood. Our motivation is built on a long-term future. It's not to sell out or to cash out partly. That's not who I am. **BT**

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